



» DURAND CUP

DEBASISH BHADURI

NEUFC's Durand Cup title a product of long-term planning and investment

NorthEast United FC defeated 17-time winner Mohun Bagan Super Giant at Salt Lake Stadium to **clinch its maiden** Durand Cup in the season-opening tournament.

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In a dramatic turnaround, NorthEast United FC emerged victorious in the 133rd Durand Cup, defeating Mohun Bagan Super Giant in a heart-stopping final. After trailing 0-2 at halftime, the team engineered a stunning comeback, levelling the score 2-2 in regular time before securing the title with a 4-3 penalty

shootout win. NorthEast United thus finished the tournament unbeaten with six consecutive victories.

The team's owner, renowned actor and producer John Abraham, captured the relief and joy of their achievement. "There's light at the end of the tunnel, and we proved it! Congratulations to the entire team and the staff. I am just a

representative standing here talking on their behalf. The real heroes are the staff, the coach, the players, and everyone involved in making this team," John said.

"Big congratulations to the team for making this happen. Also, to those fans who stood by us and supported us through thick and thin... Thank you so much!"